

ART & CULTURE



BASIC CONCEPT OF CULTURE

MODULE - 1

- WHAT IS CULTURE AND CIVILISATION
- CULTURAL HERITAGE
- GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

CONCEPT OF CULTURE



- 1** Culture is a way of life. The food you eat, the clothes you wear, the language you speak and the god you worship all are aspects of culture.
- 2** In very simple terms, culture is the embodiment of the way in which we think and do things.
- 3** It is also the things that we have inherited as members of society like the art, music, literature, architecture, religion etc.

Culture thus, refers to a human made environment, which includes all the material and non-material products of life that are transmitted from one generation to the next.

CONCEPT OF CULTURE



- 5** Culture varies from place to place and country to country.
- 6** Its development is based on the historical process operating in an local, regional or National context.
- 7** For example we differ in a ways of greeting others, or clothing , food habits and other religious practices from the West.

HOW ARE CULTURE AND CIVILIZATION DIFFERENT?



- 1 The word Culture and Civilization are often used synonymously. However, they have clearly defined meanings differentiating one from the other.
- 2 Civilization means **having better ways of living and sometimes making nature bend to fulfil human needs.**

HOW ARE CULTURE AND CIVILIZATION DIFFERENT?

CIVILIZATION

- 1 Civilization means having better ways of living and sometimes making nature bend to fulfil human needs.
- 2 It also includes **organising societies into politically well defined groups for improved conditions of life** in matters of food, dress, communication and so on.
- 3 Thus some groups consider themselves as civilized and look down upon others.

CULTURE

- 1 Culture on the other hand refers to the inner being. This includes arts and sciences and various **higher pursuits of human life**.
- 2 One who may be poor may be considered uncivilized, but still he or she may be the most cultured person.
- 3 Another possessing huge wealth may be considered as civilized but he may not be cultured.

HOW ARE CULTURE AND CIVILIZATION DIFFERENT?

- 3 Therefore to put it in simple words, Culture is the higher levels of inner refinement of a human being.



- 4 Better ways of living socially, politically, and better utilisation of nature may be termed as Civilization.

- 5 However, this is not enough to be cultured. Only when the deeper levels of a persons intellect and consciousness are brought into expression can we call him or her cultured.

“Civilized” does not mean “Cultured”

HOW DOES CULTURE GET TRANSMITTED?

- 1 Cultural development is a historical process. Our ancestors learnt many things from their predecessors.



- 2 With the passage of time they also added to it from their own experience and gave up those which they did not consider useful.
- 3 We in-turn have learnt many things from our ancestors.
- 4 As time goes we continue to add new thoughts, new ideas to those already existing.
- 5 Sometimes we give up some which we don't consider useful anymore. This is how culture is transmitted and carried forward from generation to generation.

WHAT DO YOU MEAN BY CULTURAL HERITAGE?

1 The culture we inherit from our predecessors is called our **Cultural heritage**.

2 Cultural heritage includes all those aspects and values of culture, which gets transmitted to human beings and these are cherished, protected with unbroken continuity and they feel proud of it.

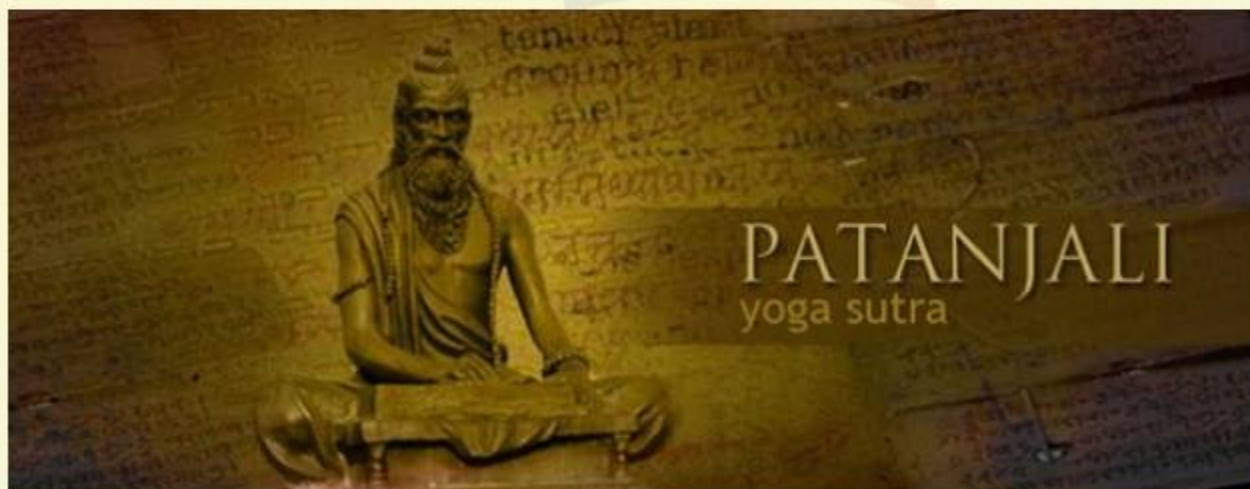
3 Nation also inherits a Culture in a similar way and this may be termed as a **National Cultural Heritage**.

4 A few examples would be helpful in clarifying the concept of heritage.
E.g. : Taj Mahal, Red Fort of Agra, Christian Church in Goa, Mysore Palace etc.



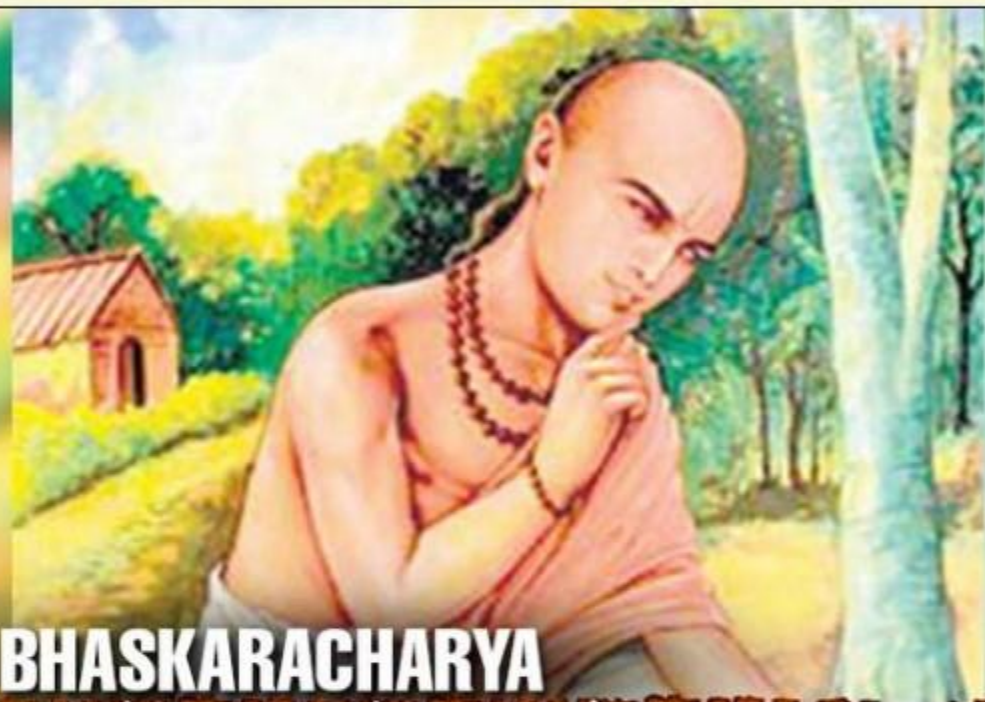
WHAT DO YOU MEAN BY CULTURAL HERITAGE?

- 5** Besides the Architectural creations, Intellectual achievements, scientific discoveries, philosophical knowledge are also the part of heritage.



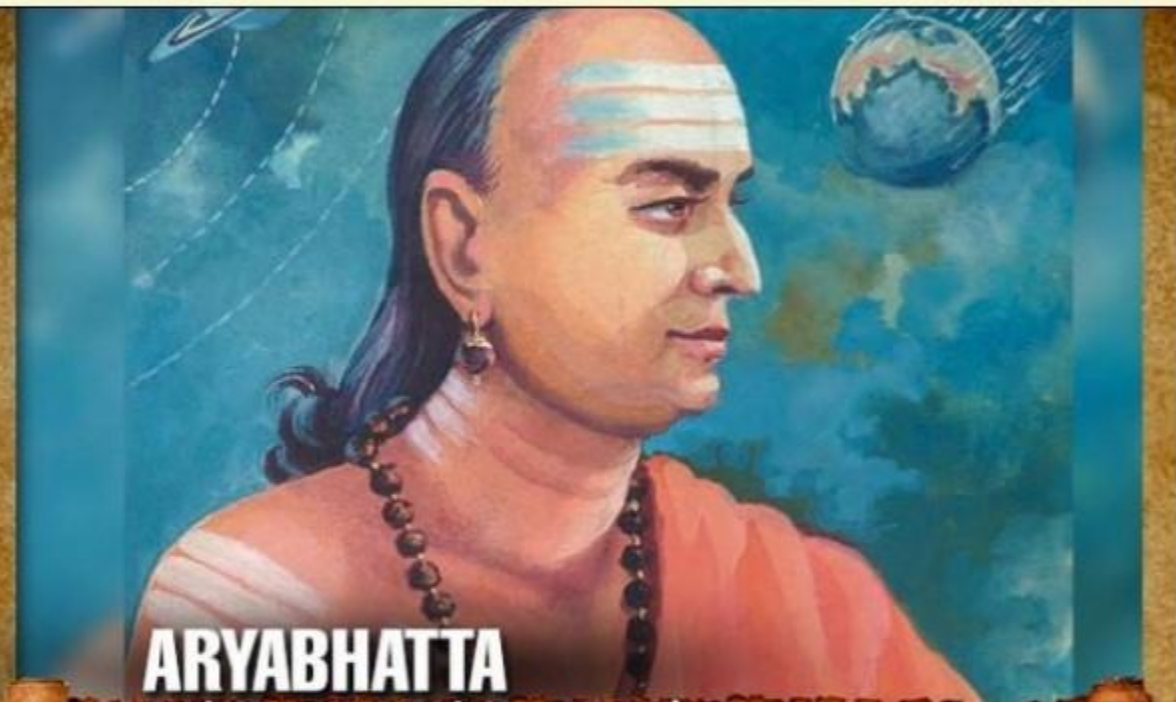
- 6** In the Indian context, the contributions of Aryabhata, Bhaskaracharya in the field of mathematics, astronomy could be cited as example.
- 7** Shushruta and Charak in the field of medicines and Patanjali in the field of yoga are profound treasures of Indian Cultural heritage.

WHAT DO YOU MEAN BY CULTURAL HERITAGE?



BHASKARACHARYA

Earth's gravitational pull was discovered by Bhaskaracharya many centuries ago.



ARYABHATTA

He invented '0' (zero) in the subject of Mathematics.

WHAT DO YOU MEAN BY CULTURAL HERITAGE?

- 8** Culture is liable to change but our heritage does not.



**MAHARISHI SUSHRUTHA-
Founding Father of Surgery**

- 10** We individuals may acquire or borrows certain cultural tradition and leave behind others. But, **our belongingness to the Indian cultural heritage will remain unchanged.**

- 11** This Indian cultural heritage will always bind us together.
E.g.: Indian literature and Scriptures namely Vedas, Upanishads, and Yoga system have contributed a lot by providing the right knowledge, right behavioural practices as a gift to the development of our civilization.

GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

POINT NO:1

CULTURE IS LEARNED AND ACQUIRED



- 1 Culture is acquired, in the sense there are certain behaviours which are acquired through heredity.
- 2 Individuals inherit certain qualities from their parents but **socio-cultural patterns are not inherited**.
- 3 These are **learnt from family members and society** in which they live.
- 4 It is thus apparent that the culture of human beings is influenced by the physical and social environment through which they operate.

GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

POINT NO:2

CULTURE IS SHARED BY A GROUP OF PEOPLE

A thought or action may be called Culture if it is shared and believed and practiced by a group of people.



GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

POINT NO:3

CULTURE IS CUMMULATIVE

- 1 Different knowledge embodied in culture is passed from one generation to another.
- 2 More knowledge is added to this particular culture as the time passes by.
- 3 This cycle of adding more and more knowledge is a cumulative cycle and remains to be carried forward with every generation.

POINT NO:4

CULTURE CHANGES

- 1 There is knowledge, thoughts or traditions that are lost as new cultural traits are added.
- 2 Thus there is a possibility for culture getting changed as time passes.

GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

POINT NO:5

CULTURE IS DYNAMIC



- 1 No culture remains on the permanent State.
- 2 Culture is changing constantly as new ideas and new techniques are added modifying the old ways.
- 3 This is the characteristic of culture that stems from the culture's cumulative quality.

GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

POINT NO:6

CULTURE IS DIVERSE



1 It is a system that has several mutually interdependent parts.

2 These parts can act separately but they are interdependent on one another, thus forming the whole body which is known as Culture.

GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

POINT NO:7

CULTURE GIVES US A RANGE OF PERMISSIBLE BEHAVIOUR PATTERNS

- 1 Culture involves how an activity should be conducted and how an individual should act appropriately.
- 2 Thus it gives us a set of permissible behaviour patterns.

POINT NO:8

CULTURE IS IDEATIONAL

- 1 Culture lays down an ideal pattern of behaviour that are expected to be followed by individuals who has to gain social acceptance from the people with the same culture.

IMPORTANCE OF CULTURE IN HUMAN LIFE



- 1** Culture is closely linked with human life. **It is what makes us human.**
- 2** Culture is made up of traditions, beliefs, way of life. **It gives us meaning and a way of leading our lives.**
- 3** **Human beings are creators of cultures and at the same time culture is what makes us human.**
- 4** As the world is becoming more and more global the need for co-existence makes the co-existence of culture and beliefs absolutely necessary.

IMPORTANCE OF CULTURE IN HUMAN LIFE

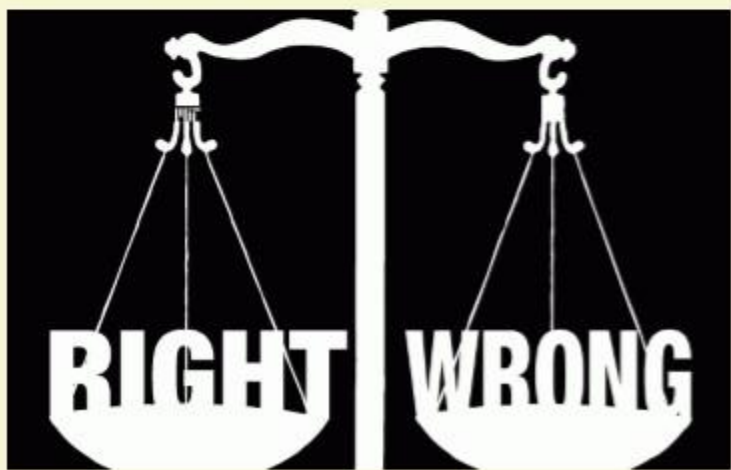


- 5 The best thing we can do to know other cultures is to get to know our own.
- 6 The three eternal and the universal values in India are truth, goodness and beauty- Sathyam, Shivam, Sundharam.
- 7 These three aspects are closely linked with Indian Culture. It is this culture that brings us closer to the inner truth through philosophy and religion.

INTERESTING PHILOSOPHICAL QUOTES AND THEIR RELATED INSTITUTIONS....

INSTITUTION	MOTTO	MEANING
Republic of India	Satymeva Jayate	Truth alone Triumphs
Supreme Court of India	Yato Dharmas Tato Jayah	Whence Dharma thence victory
LIC	Yogakshemam Vahamyaham	I shall take care of welfare
Doordarshan	Satyam Shivam Sundaram	Truth is God & God is beautiful
Research and Analysis Wing	Dharmo Rakshati Rakshitah	Righteousness protects if protected

WHAT REALLY HAPPENS TODAY?



- 1** Today, in India we are witnessing neither the continuation of traditional norms and values nor the complete institutionalization of newly introduced values.
- 2** We are witnessing an intermediate situation containing elements of both tradition and modernity. A cultural crisis too is evident.
- 3** Few follow and practice the cultural values. There is a clear contradiction between inner beliefs and the actual behaviour.

WHAT REALLY HAPPENS TODAY?



4 Their seems to be a general de-humanization, de-sensitization, in the individual of today.

5 Honesty and Integrity are at the discount today and this adversely affects every aspect of life.

6 The crisis of the value system and distorted and contradictory norms and behaviour are the ultimate causes of the present day problems.

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